

SOUND LIKE MONK!

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #128

Let's say we want to learn a lick, a device that #1) is super hip, #2) is very functional, very "inside the changes," and #3) has a real vibe, something that has some serious personality to it. You know what? This sounds like a job for Thelonious Monk, Jazz Super Hero!

#1 - What is a hip melodic sound? The interval of a tritone is! It's angular, maybe a bit challenging to hear or play, and used to get you excommunicated from the church. Yikes. Monk loved tritones.

#2 - What would be very functional, very inside the chord changes? Well, the 3rds and 7ths of a chord are the very definition of "functional" in music theory. And on a dominant chord, the 3rd and the 7th create the interval of a tritone. Monk loved tritones.

#3 - What has a real "sound" to it? Béla Bartók, Igor Stravinsky, Claude Debussy and Jimi Hendrix all dug the vibe of the tritone, and used it to great effect in their music. And you know what? Monk loved tritones too. In short, any club that has Béla, Igor, Claude, Jimi and Thelonious as members . . . you want to join that club!

#1 - C Blues w/ tritones

